
AGE OF RUIN BESTIARY, ECOSYSTEM & THREAT GUIDE

Minecraft Java 26.2 | Datapack v3.1

PLAYER GUIDE ONLY

This guide describes what players encounter: world scaling, spawn odds, affixes, evolved mobs, the Nether, events, bosses, loot, level-255 enchantment progression, legendary fishing and heritable animal traits. It contains no installation, administration or command instructions.

DIFFICULTY -> REWARD -> POWER -> NEW DIFFICULTY

The world ages. Your progression corrupts it faster. Hostile mobs evolve, the Nether becomes a second escalation layer, and even peaceful livestock can develop valuable inherited traits.

1. World Threat, Corruption & Eras

Threat = World Day + permanent Corruption. The calendar sets the minimum difficulty. Major progression milestones add Corruption, so a fast group cannot rush powerful gear while leaving the ecosystem at early-game strength.

Milestone	Permanent Threat increase
First diamond	+1
First Nether entry	+3
First netherite ingot	+3
Each custom major boss	+5
Ender Dragon	+15
Wither	+5

Era thresholds

Threat	Era	Main shift
1-5	Calm	Mostly vanilla pressure; rare enhanced mobs begin.
6-15	Awakening	Elite affixes and stronger equipment appear.
16-30	Corruption	Mini-bosses and evolved variants become established.
31-50	Blood Age	Patrols, siege behavior and harsher nights.
51-75	Cataclysm	More events, Greater Elites and dangerous caves.
76-100	Ascension	High enchantment tiers and severe ranged threats.
101-150	Doom	Dragon/Wither-tier combat and Legendary enemies.
151+	Endless Ruin	No final safe plateau; durability and damage keep climbing.

Daily raw scaling

Target durability: $\text{Base Health} \times (1 + \text{Threat} \times 0.015)$. Attack damage: $\text{Base Damage} \times (1 + \text{Threat} \times 0.010)$. When native health reaches Minecraft's safe entity ceiling, excess durability is represented through absorption; later Resistance tiers keep extreme Threat meaningful.

Threat	Health	Damage	Extra durability
20	+30%	+20%	None
50	+75%	+50%	None
100	+150%	+100%	None
150	+225%	+150%	Resistance I begins
250	+375%	+250%	Resistance II
400	+600%	+400%	Resistance III
600+	+900% at 600	+600% at 600	Resistance IV + continued pools

2. Daily Threat Report & Spawn Odds

At the start of every new Minecraft day, all online players receive a world-status report in chat. It shows the current Day, Threat, Corruption, Era, enemy health and damage bonuses, Elite/Greater/Mini-boss odds, the Blood Moon roll, event forecast, advanced rarity rules, Nether pressure and the active breeding-genetics rates.

Base hostile rarity

Threat	Elite	Greater Elite	Mini-boss
1	1.0%	0.0%	0.0%
10	5.0%	0.5%	0.0%
25	10.0%	2.0%	0.2%
50	16.0%	4.0%	0.5%
75	22.0%	6.0%	1.0%
100	27.0%	8.0%	1.5%
150	35.0%	10.0%	2.5%
200+	35.0%	10.0%	3.0%

Advanced rarity promotions

Tier	Rule
Epic	From Threat 50 onward, 12.5% of Greater Elites are promoted to Epic.
Legendary	From Threat 100 onward, 2.5% of Greater Elites are promoted to Legendary.
Mythic	Reserved for purpose-built boss encounters and top-tier special rewards rather than ordinary spawn promotion.

Blood Moon roll

Threat	Nightly chance
Below 7	0%
7	5%
25	8%
50	12%
75	16%
100	20%
150	25%
200+	30%

CADENCE

Blood Moons have a 7-day minimum separation. If the world reaches a 12-day drought, the next eligible Blood Moon is forced instead of allowing indefinitely lucky avoidance.

3. Enemy Rarity & Reward Ladder

Tier	Affixes / identity	Reward profile
Normal	No rarity affixes	Vanilla loot plus any evolved-mob equipment.
Elite	1-3 affixes; green identity	Soul Shard plus bonus gold, emerald, lapis, diamond or rare book rolls.
Greater Elite	3-5 affixes; blue identity	Greater Soul plus better diamond, enchanted-book and netherite-scrap rolls.
Epic	Greater base + Epic promotion; purple	Additive Greater rewards plus guaranteed diamonds and a high-end reward roll such as Sharpness XII, Power XII, Protection X or netherite.
Legendary	Greater base + Legendary promotion; gold	Additive rewards, diamonds/netherite scrap and a Legendary gear/book roll around levels 20-25.
Mythic	Boss / exceptional catch identity	Unique relics, Ancient Souls and extreme late-game equipment.

Risk/reward states

Blood Moons and Blessing-type reward states double custom Soul payouts. This means the most dangerous nights are deliberately among the best times to hunt instead of purely being nights to hide.

Why tiers stay dangerous

Rarity is layered on top of global Threat scaling and mob-specific evolution. A late-game Legendary is therefore not simply a named mob with extra health: it can combine Greater-tier affixes, a specialized evolved variant, global Resistance and event modifiers at the same time.

4. Elite Affixes - Offensive & Mobility

Affix	Effect
Brutal	Adds roughly +60% total attack damage.
Swift	Adds roughly +45% movement speed.
Vampiric	Close-range pulse damages a nearby player and heals the mob.
Berserker	At low health, gains a major Strength and Speed spike.
Stormborn	Periodically calls lightning onto a nearby player.
Venomous	Applies Poison at close range.
Withering	Applies Wither at close range.
Frostbound	Applies heavy Slowness and freezing pressure.
Infernal	Fire-resistant, ignites nearby targets and creates fire pressure.
Explosive	Triggers controlled close-range explosions; intended for combat pressure rather than indiscriminate base deletion.
Blinking	Short-range teleports disrupt kiting and line-of-sight play.
Leeching	Drains nearby player health/absorption and sustains itself.
Executioner	Deals sharply increased pressure to low-health players.

COMBINATION EXAMPLE

A Swift + Vampiric + Berserker enemy is difficult for a different reason than an Armored + Commander + Regenerating enemy. The system is designed around interaction between affixes, not only larger damage numbers.

5. Elite Affixes - Defense, Control & Siege

Affix	Effect
Armored	Adds armor and armor toughness.
Regenerating	Periodically restores health.
Juggernaut	Large durability bonus, strong knockback resistance and reduced mobility.
Necromancer	Periodically summons weaker undead support.
Commander	Bufs nearby hostile mobs; killing the Commander removes the local buff source.
Reflective	Periodically punishes projectile-heavy play and can return ranged pressure.
Hexed	Applies rotating debuffs such as Weakness, Slowness or Blindness.
Phasewalker	Receives temporary high-resistance / immunity-like windows, preventing constant DPS.
Architect	Builds cobblestone bridges and pillars to reach platforms or cross simple gaps.

Affix counts

Elite: 1-3 distinct affixes. Greater Elite: 3-5 distinct affixes. Epic and Legendary enemies inherit Greater-level complexity and add their own rarity pressure/reward layer.

Readable danger

Affix particles, names and obvious mechanics are intentional. Players should be able to recognize why a target is dangerous and choose priorities - especially Commanders, Necromancers, Phasewalkers and Architects.

6. Evolved Undead & Creepers

Zombie line

Variant	Behavior
Armored Zombie	Heavy armor/toughness version.
Plague Zombie	Poison pressure and disease-themed aura.
Berserker	Accelerates and hits harder when wounded.
Dread Knight	Late-game armored melee threat with high resistance to knockback and strong equipment.

Skeleton line

Variant	Behavior
Ranger	Fast movement and rapid ranged pressure.
Sniper	Slower cadence but extremely high single-shot damage.
Necrotic Archer	Wither-themed projectile pressure.
Storm Archer	Lightning-based ranged pressure.
Phantom Archer	Teleports after attacks to break predictable cover play.
Parched evolutions	Sunscorched Sniper, Dust Hexer and Sandstorm Archer extend the ranged ecosystem into dry-biome 26.2 threats.

Creeper line

Variant	Behavior
Charged Creeper	Rare natural charged variant.
Fragmentation Creeper	Adds secondary explosive pressure.
Void Creeper	Teleports toward targets before detonation.
Necrotic Creeper	Creates Wither-themed aftermath.
Titan Creeper	Very high durability and a slower, highly telegraphed catastrophic detonation.

7. Spiders, Illagers & Swarm Mobs

Spiders

Variant	Behavior
Webspinner	Slows nearby players and turns open ground into a control problem.
Broodmother	Summons additional spider pressure.
Leaping Hunter	High-mobility pursuit variant.
Venomweaver	Enhanced poison/control identity, especially dangerous in caves.

Pillager / raid ecosystem

Mob	Special variants
Pillager	Bombardier, Hexshot, War Captain, Sapper. Explosions, Weakness, Command buffs and siege pressure.
Vindicator	Executioner, Blood Axe, Doorbreaker. High melee burst and anti-base behavior.
Evoker / Illusioner	Riftcaller, Storm Mage, Hexmaster. Vexes, lightning, teleport/control magic.
Ravager	Siege Beast, Ironhide, Quake Beast. Wall pressure, durability and shockwaves.
Vex	Soulblade, Leeching Vex, Blinkblade. Fast phase-like melee disruption.

Swarm threats

Mob	Special variants
Silverfish	Swarmcaller, Phase Burrower, Corrosive Silverfish.
Endermite	Void Leech, Blinkmite, Swarm Seed.

8. The Nether: A Second Difficulty Layer

GLOBAL NETHER PRESSURE

Nether mobs receive the normal world-Threat scaling and an additional Nether modifier: approximately +25% durability and damage, Elite odds x1.25, Greater/Mini-boss odds x1.5, and extra movement pressure at higher Threat.

Infernal Warbands

The Nether can generate coordinated warbands rather than isolated mobs: Piglin Brutes, Piglins, Blazes and Hoglins can arrive together, with at least one forced Greater-level threat and siege-capable members. This makes tunnels and small safe ledges less absolute.

Soul Storms

From roughly Threat 75 onward, the Nether can produce Soul Storm pressure with Wither Skeletons and Ghosts. These episodes are designed to punish long exposed crossings and under-defended Nether infrastructure.

Domestic Nether progression

Striders participate in the heritable gene ecosystem. A long-running Nether base can therefore breed faster, tougher or more valuable Strider lines instead of the dimension being only an enemy zone.

The Nether modifier stacks with Blood Moons/events, evolved variants, Elite affixes and normal Threat. Late-game Nether exploration is therefore substantially more dangerous than fighting the same nominal mob in a neutral context.

9. Nether Evolved Variants

Family	Special variants / mechanics
Blaze	Inferno Lord, Solar Flare, Phoenix Blaze - Commander/Infernal pressure, explosive fire damage, regeneration/phase behavior.
Ghast	Hellstorm Ghast, Soul Screamer, Siege Ghast - large explosive zones, pressure attacks and base-breaking identity.
Magma Cube	Molten Juggernaut, Volcanic Splitter, Ash Leech - tanking, splitting/add pressure and sustain.
Piglin	Warleader, Gold-Cursed, Spear Charger - Command buffs, reflective/brutal traits and high-mobility spear pressure.
Piglin Brute	Butcher, Juggernaut Brute, Brute Executioner - extreme melee emphasis.
Zombified Piglin	Ash Berserker, Spear Reaver, Soulbound - enrage, spear mobility and Wither/regeneration.
Hoglin / Zoglin	Gorebeast, Bristleback, Siege Boar - charge, durability and structure pressure.
Sulfur Cubes	Volatile Sulfur Cube, Noxious Cube, Sticky Hunter - explosions, Poison and control.

Nether mobs can still roll normal affixes on top of their family variant. A Warleader Piglin can therefore also become Armored, Stormborn or Necromancer, for example.

10. End, Deep Dark & Ocean Threats

Family	Special variants / mechanics
Enderman	Void Stalker, Phase Enderman, Abyssal Grasp - teleporting, phase windows and control.
Shulker	Void Artillery, Reflective Shell, Phase Shell - ranged zone control and anti-projectile behavior.
Warden	Echo Tyrant, Phase Warden, Warden Executioner - stronger sonic/darkness pressure and execution mechanics.
Creaking	Root Reaper, Phase Creaking, Dreadwood - phase/control variants for Pale Garden encounters.
Guardian	Shock Guardian, Tidecaller, Armored Guardian - electrical pressure, support buffs and durability.
Elder Guardian	Abyssal Elder, Storm Elder, Tide Tyrant - hexes, storms, sustain and Command support.
Zombie Nautilus	Abyssal Charger, Drowned Bulwark, Tide Leech - mobility, tanking and sustain.
Drowned	Uses the broader undead/evolution system and receives ocean/Threat scaling.

The Deep Dark remains mechanically distinct

The Abyssal Stalker and Warden-family evolutions use Darkness, teleportation/phase behavior, sonic pressure and misleading Warden-like audio. The goal is not just to create a Warden with more health, but to make navigation and orientation part of the encounter.

11. Other Aggressive & Potentially Aggressive Mobs

Family	Special features
Witch	Plague Witch, Storm Witch, Coven Mother - summons, storm pressure and ally buffs.
Breeze	Tempest, Stormborn Breeze, Phase Breeze - mobility, levitation and phase pressure.
Phantom	Night Terror, Vampiric Wing, Hexwing - execution, sustain and debuffs.
Slime	Acidic Slime, Splitting Horror, Vault Slime - corrosive debuffs, additional splits and tank/mobility mixes.
Polar Bear	Enhanced combat variant with increased durability and damage potential.
Bee	Royal Bee special variant; gene-bearing bees can also become valuable support animals.
Pufferfish	Toxic special variant with stronger poison identity.
Camel Husk	Boneback, Dune Charger and Grave Caravan traits turn the passive undead mount/rider ecosystem into a special encounter.
Zombie Horse	Dread Steed, Grave Charger and Soul Steed variants.
Iron / Snow / Copper Golems	Can receive special defensive, frost or arcane identities rather than remaining completely static utility mobs.

The intent is comprehensive coverage: ordinary hostility, conditional aggression, mounted threats and utility mobs all have ways to become mechanically different from vanilla rather than only Zombies, Skeletons and Creepers receiving attention.

12. Hordes, Patrols & Siege Behavior

Undead Patrols

From roughly Threat 30 onward, ordinary nights can spawn coordinated patrols: a Commander Zombie, three armored Zombies, two Skeletons and an additional Elite. The Commander buffs nearby mobs until removed.

Base invasions

Long-term worlds can receive three-wave attacks on player positions. Early waves use numbers, later waves add Elites/Commanders, and the final wave introduces mini-boss pressure. Surviving the attack is rewarded rather than only damaging the base.

Breaking into houses

Siege-capable enemies can remove selected common defensive blocks such as doors, glass and common masonry rather than treating a basic house as absolute safety. Explosive affixes are deliberately more controlled than normal terrain-destroying TNT-style grief.

Reaching platforms

Architect mobs place cobblestone to bridge gaps and pillar upward when players retreat onto elevated platforms. This does not replace Minecraft's pathfinder, but it changes the terrain so native AI can gain routes that would otherwise be impossible.

FORTIFICATION STILL MATTERS

Obsidian is deliberately outside the routine siege-break list. Late-game bases can become genuinely fortified, but doing so takes more investment than closing an oak door.

13. Blood Moons & World Events

Blood Moon modifiers

Modifier	Effect
Hostile pressure	Approximately +100% spawn pressure.
Elite chance	x2.
Mini-boss chance	x3.
Durability	+25% on top of normal Threat.
Damage	+20% on top of normal Threat.
Custom rare rewards	x2 Soul payouts.
Sleeping	Disabled for the Blood Moon night.

Other world events

Event	What changes
Undead Invasion	Zombie armies / invasion waves pressure player positions.
The Hunt	Elite hunting pressure rises.
Nether Incursion	Nether mobs invade Overworld space.
Black Night	Darkness and stronger night monsters.
Storm of Wrath	Thunder and Stormborn enemy pressure.
Plague	A high share of Zombies become Plague variants.
Endstorm	Sustained Enderman / End pressure.
Bounty	Mini-boss opportunities rise.
Blessing	Rare positive event with enhanced custom rewards.

14. Natural Mini-Bosses - I

Boss	Host / identity	Core mechanics
Grave Knight	Wither Skeleton	Armored, Brutal, Executioner and Berserker. Projectile-defense phase, Death Charge, Grave Call and low-health enrage.
Plaguebringer	Husk	Poison clouds, Plague Zombie summons and regeneration while its disease pressure remains active.
Stormcaller	Evoker	Lightning, Vex summons, shockwaves and teleporting.
Abyssal Stalker	Enderman / Deep Dark	Darkness, teleportation, sonic pressure and fake Warden-like sounds to disrupt orientation.
Ashen Executioner	Wither Skeleton	Infernal, Brutal and Executioner; strong low-health finishing pressure.
Bone Colossus	Undead heavy	High durability and crowd-control / brute-force identity.

Natural mini-bosses appear through the mini-boss probability rather than needing a handcrafted arena. They are intended to turn ordinary exploration into occasional boss-like encounters.

15. Natural Mini-Bosses - II

Boss	Theme	Core identity
Dread Marshal	Undead commander	Bufs/summons allied enemies and creates priority-target combat.
Frost Warden	Cold control	Slowness/freezing pressure with tanky frontline behavior.
Infernal Huntmaster	Nether hunter	Fast fire-based pursuit with Infernal support.
Plague Matron	Disease summoner	Poison/summon pressure and sustain.
Rift Stalker	Teleport assassin	Blinking/phase mechanics and unpredictable engagement range.
Void Reaver	End / void	Leeching, teleportation and high-value late-game pressure.

Mini-boss rewards

Mini-bosses are a primary source of Ancient Souls and other high-end progression components. Their drops bridge the gap between Greater-Elite farming and major-boss relics.

16. Major Bosses Before / Around the Dragon

Boss	Approx. 1-player base	Approx. 4-player target	Identity
Grave King	2,200	6,490	Undead sovereign with heavy add pressure and Grave-themed relic progression.
Infernal Behemoth	2,200	6,490	Ravager-like infernal tank with Blazes/Magma adds, fire and explosive pressure.
Abyss Watcher	2,400	7,080	Warden-like Darkness/sonic/phase boss. Drops Abyssal Essence.
Leviathan	2,500	7,375	Elder Guardian aquatic raid with Guardians/Drowned, fatigue and tide pressure.

Custom major bosses scale toward Base x (1 + 0.65 x additional nearby players). Their effective durability uses valid health, absorption and Resistance combinations rather than invalid multi-thousand native-health values.

NO DRAGON KEY

These bosses provide progression materials and powerful rewards, but they do not create an inventory key that allows Dragon damage. The Dragon is always mechanically accessible whenever vanilla Minecraft permits it.

17. Ender Dragon - The World Eater

UNLOCKED, NOT EASY

The Dragon never checks armor, bow level or prior boss kills. The intended four-player fight is simply tuned so an early vanilla-style rush is overwhelmingly difficult.

Phase	Range	Pressure
I	100-75%	Vanilla crystal fight plus stronger breath and Endermite pressure.
II	75-50%	The End awakens: Shulkers and Endermen join, Darkness rises and crystal pressure can return.
III	50-25%	Aggression rises further with End adds and stronger ranged/area pressure.
IV	25-0%	World Eater enrages: severe breath damage, Darkness and constant movement requirement.

Durability and expected gear

For four nearby players the encounter is built around roughly 5,000+ effective HP. A sensible target remains around full Netherite, Protection VIII and a Power X bow. That is a practical combat recommendation, never a hard requirement.

After the kill

The Dragon grants Heart of the End / high-end progression rewards and adds +15 permanent Corruption, so victory immediately makes the rest of the world more dangerous.

18. Wither - Harbinger of Extinction

HARDER THAN THE DRAGON

The Wither is intentionally the harsher vanilla boss. It remains summonable whenever vanilla allows it, but its multi-phase durability and team pressure make early cheese substantially less reliable.

Phase	Trigger	Pressure
I	100-70%	Airborne Wither behavior plus repeated Wither Skeleton pairs and team-wide Wither pressure.
II	70%	Shield/refill phase, stronger Wither effects and explosive pressure.
III	40%	"Death Has Come": major shockwave, another durability refill and elite Wither Skeleton pressure.
IV	15%	Extinction DPS race: no more healing, self-decay and extreme damage pressure.

Four-player cumulative effective durability is roughly 8,700+ across its phase refills. The intended gear tier is around Protection IX, Power XI and Sharpness X+ or better - again, recommendation rather than lock.

Victory adds additional permanent Corruption and provides Heart of Extinction / Ancient Soul progression.

19. Post-Wither Major Bosses - I

Boss	Approx. 4P target	Core mechanics
Ancient Colossus	10,030	Four weak points protect the core; massive shockwave attacks and extreme tanking until weak points fall.
Lich King	8,850	Phylacteries sustain defenses/healing; repeated undead summons, Wither and Weakness pressure.
Infernal Titan	11,210	Infernal/Juggernaut/Explosive raid with large Blaze/Magma waves and major area damage. Phoenix-themed reward line.

These fights are intended for players already beyond ordinary vanilla gear. Their mechanics prevent a level-50 or level-100 weapon from automatically converting every boss into a stationary damage sponge.

20. Post-Wither Major Bosses - II

Boss	Approx. 4P target	Core mechanics
Warden King	12,390	Armored/Phasewalker/Executioner; sustained Darkness, sonic punishment and lethal close-range pressure.
Storm Herald	9,440	Stormborn/Blinking/Reflective; lightning, Vex/Breeze adds and anti-projectile pressure.
Void Emperor	14,750	Phasewalker/Blinking/Reflective/Leeching; Shulker/Endermite adds, Darkness and absorption-draining void pressure.

ENDGAME DESIGN

The Void Emperor is built to remain mechanically dangerous even with extreme enchantment levels. Phase windows, reflection, teleportation, leeching and adds force decision-making instead of pure face-tanking.

21. Souls, Relics & Legendary Equipment

Reward	Source / role
Soul Shard	Core Elite currency.
Greater Soul	Higher rarity currency from Greater Elites.
Ancient Soul	Mini-boss and major-boss progression material.
Gravecaller	Legendary sword: kills can summon a temporary allied Gravebound Skeleton.
Stormbreaker	Legendary axe: player hits can call lightning on hostile targets.
Voidpiercer	Legendary bow: void arrows can damage multiple hostiles along their path.
Bloodletter	Legendary sword: major Strength boost while the wielder is critically low.
Phoenix Plate	Legendary chestplate: emergency Resistance/Regeneration/fire burst with a long cooldown.
Tidebreaker	High-end Leviathan trident with very strong aquatic damage/durability.

Legendary and Mythic power is not confined to bosses anymore: very high Luck of the Sea can also pull extraordinary relics and high-level enchanted equipment from fishing. Bosses remain the most deterministic source of named progression materials.

22. Every Vanilla Enchantment Can Reach 255

Age of Ruin v3.1 extends the level ceiling of all 43 vanilla enchantments present in Minecraft Java 26.2 to level 255 through the Soul-based progression system. The item must already be compatible with and possess the enchantment before it can be raised, preserving normal item compatibility and enchantment exclusivity.

Group	Enchantments
Damage / melee	Sharpness, Smite, Bane of Arthropods, Fire Aspect, Knockback, Sweeping Edge, Density, Breach, Wind Burst, Lunge.
Ranged	Power, Punch, Flame, Infinity, Piercing, Multishot, Quick Charge.
Trident / spear / water combat	Impaling, Loyalty, Riptide, Channeling.
Armor defense	Protection, Blast Protection, Fire Protection, Projectile Protection, Feather Falling, Thorns.
Movement / utility armor	Frost Walker, Depth Strider, Soul Speed, Swift Sneak, Respiration, Aqua Affinity.
Tools / drops	Efficiency, Fortune, Silk Touch, Looting, Unbreaking, Mending.
Fishing	Luck of the Sea, Lure.
Curses	Curse of Binding, Curse of Vanishing.

LEVEL DOES NOT ALWAYS MEAN LINEAR EFFECT

Some vanilla enchantments are binary or internally capped by Minecraft mechanics. They can still be raised to 255 as part of the universal progression system, but level 255 Infinity or Mending does not imply 255 times the vanilla effect. Combat/stat enchantments are where extreme levels matter most.

23. Extreme Enchantment Progression

Current level band	Cost / progression character
Below 10	Entry high-enchantment progression; cheap relative to late game.
10-24	Noticeably higher Soul cost.
25-49	Greater/Epic hunting becomes a practical resource source.
50-99	Late-game grind; strong fishing and boss gear begin to compete with forging.
100-199	Extreme long-term progression; high Threat increasingly expects these values.
200-254	Final grind band; enormous resource commitment for each additional level.
255	Hard engine/design ceiling for the progression.

Protection beyond vanilla

Vanilla Protection has an effective reduction ceiling, so Age of Ruin adds secondary defensive scaling based on total Protection across the armor set. A combined total around 32+ (full Prot VIII) activates an important Resistance breakpoint; much higher totals continue toward Resistance III and IV. This keeps Protection 20, 50 or 100 meaningful in an Endless Ruin world.

Why Sharpness 255 eventually matters

Global durability grows every Threat point, large pools convert into absorption, and high Threat adds Resistance I-IV. At sufficiently old/corrupted worlds, low-enchantment weapons become functionally inefficient against ordinary evolved mobs, not only bosses. Extreme Sharpness/Power levels are the intended answer to that long-tail scaling.

24. Luck of the Sea: Legendary & Mythic Fishing

Very high Luck of the Sea adds bonus Legendary/Mythic reward rolls to successful fishing catches. Mythic is checked first, then Legendary. These are bonus Age of Ruin treasure rolls rather than ordinary vanilla treasure quality.

Luck of the Sea	Legendary chance	Mythic chance
10-24	0.05%	0%
25-49	0.15%	0.005%
50-99	0.40%	0.020%
100-149	1.00%	0.080%
150-199	2.00%	0.200%
200-254	4.00%	0.500%
255	7.50%	1.250%

Legendary catch examples

Abyssal Harpoon: Netherite spear around Sharpness 45 / Lunge 25. Tideglass Bow: Power 55. Leviathan Plate: Protection 45. Pearl Rod: Luck 70 / Lure 60. Stormhook: Impaling 60. Deepwalker Boots: Protection 40 with extreme movement enchants. High Luck/Mending books can also appear.

Mythic catch examples

Rod of the Drowned King: Luck 255 / Lure 200. Poseidon's Wrath: Impaling 255 trident. Ocean's End: Sharpness 180 / Looting 120 sword. Abyss Crown: Protection 150 helmet. Final Catch: Sharpness 255 Netherite spear. A Luck of the Sea 255 book is also in the Mythic pool.

25. Heritable Passive & Neutral Mob Genetics

Friendly and neutral mobs can develop special traits that behave like genes. Ordinary genes can accumulate and be inherited independently. Invincible is the exception: it is a mutation-only trait and cannot be passed directly from a parent.

Mechanic	Probability / behavior
Natural special animal	18% chance for a newly initialized gene-pool animal to receive a primary ordinary gene.
Natural second mutation	Gene-bearing natural animals have a small additional mutation chance for another ordinary trait.
One-parent inheritance	55% chance to inherit each ordinary gene carried by exactly one parent.
Two-parent inheritance	85% chance to inherit an ordinary gene carried by both parents.
Offspring mutation	3% chance for an additional ordinary mutation after inheritance.
Invincible mutation	0.25% per bred offspring (1 in 400), rolled independently of the parents.
Invincible inheritance	Never. An Invincible parent does not pass Invincible to offspring.
Invincible breeding	Sterile once adult; it cannot be used as a breeding parent.

INVINCIBLE MUTATION

An Invincible newborn is an exceptional terminal bloodline: keep it as a permanent resource animal, because the trait cannot be stabilized through inheritance. The 1-in-400 roll happens on breeding even when neither parent has rare genes.

Direct-birth animals use the actual two breeding parents for ordinary inheritance. Invincible is evaluated separately after the breeding event, so Golden x Alchemist, for example, can still combine normally while the same offspring independently has the 0.25% Invincible mutation chance.

26. The Ten Genetic Traits

Gene	Phenotype / benefit
Vigor	Approximately +50% maximum health.
Swift	Approximately +30% movement speed.
Guardian	High knockback resistance; combat-capable species also gain stronger attack potential.
Primal	Approximately +25% health, larger body scale and stronger attacks where applicable.
Gourmet	Species-specific enhanced food production or cooked-food drops.
Golden	Species-specific gold production / gold drops.
Arcane	Magical support aura or Arcane/Soul-themed rewards depending on species.
Lucky	Rare material drops or Luck-support effects depending on species.
Alchemist	Cows/goats can yield an additional infused potion draught when milked.
Invincible	Mutation-only. Cannot die in ordinary survival combat; adult is sterile; successful hits release renewable species resources instead of killing it.

Invincible phenotype

Invincible animals emit Totem particles. Their health and absorption are continuously restored and they maintain heavy damage resistance. Hitting one causes its species resource package to appear at its feet - for example beef and leather from a cow, pork from a pig, wool and mutton from a sheep, or species-appropriate utility resources from animals that normally have little death loot.

If an Invincible animal also carries productive genes such as Gourmet, Golden, Arcane, Lucky or Alchemist, those traits can add extra resources to the hit payout. Because Invincible animals cannot breed, a multi-gene Invincible animal is a rare final phenotype rather than a gene line that can be mass-produced.

BALANCE RULE

Invincible is deliberately not part of the 55% / 85% inheritance system. Its value comes from finding the mutation, not from turning one lucky animal into an infinite breeding stock.

27. Gene Species & Valuable Bloodlines

Species / gene	Special benefit
Gourmet Cow	Drops additional cooked beef when killed by a player.
Golden Cow	Drops gold; useful as a breedable resource line.
Arcane Cow	Can yield Soul-themed progression material.
Alchemist Cow	Milking can additionally provide a strong/long potion draught.
Gourmet Pig	Drops additional cooked pork.
Golden Pig	Drops gold nuggets with a chance for an ingot.
Golden Chicken	Can produce gold-nugget value on kill.
Lucky Rabbit	Emerald / rabbit-foot reward line.
Arcane Sheep	Lapis-themed reward line.
Lucky Fox	Emerald reward line.
Golden Turtle	Gold reward line.
Golden Armadillo	Gold-nugget reward line.
Lucky Sniffer	Rare diamond or emerald reward potential.
Alchemist Goat	Milk interaction can provide infused potion rewards.

Support-animal examples

Guardian Wolf: nearby owner/player receives Strength support. Arcane Axolotl: regeneration aura. Arcane Bee: Haste aura. Lucky Cat: Luck aura. Striders: can inherit Vigor, Swift, Primal, Golden and Lucky traits, creating a dedicated Nether breeding line.

28. Special Neutral & Friendly Variants

Not every passive/neutral feature needs to be a breedable gene. Several utility or conditionally aggressive mobs also receive direct special variants.

Mob	Special feature examples
Iron Golem	Sentinel / Bastion / Arcane identities with enhanced combat or utility.
Snow Golem	Frost variant with stronger cold-control identity.
Copper Golem	Arcane variant with enhanced health/mobility.
Bee	Royal Bee support variant in addition to inheritable genes.
Polar Bear	Stronger combat variant.
Pufferfish	Toxic variant.
Allay	Arcane Allay with nearby regeneration support.
Bat	Echo Bat.
Parrot	Lucky Parrot with Luck support.
Squid	Ink Squid.
Glow Squid	Arcane Glow Squid with Water Breathing support.
Skeleton Horse	Grave Skeleton Horse.
Villager	Blessed Villager with Hero-of-the-Village-style support.
Wandering Trader	Arcane Trader variant.
Dolphin	Tide Dolphin with stronger Dolphin's Grace support.

This system makes exploration and animal collection matter in a second way: a rare friendly phenotype can be a permanent base asset, a breeding project or a resource-production line rather than disposable scenery.

29. Long-Term Progression Expectations

Stage	Approx. target	Typical player power
Early Survival	Threat 1-10	Iron / Diamond; ordinary enchantments.
Elite Age	10-25	Diamond + stable vanilla enchants.
Nether	20-35	Netherite begins; Nether-specific pressure matters.
Early bosses	30-50	Protection V-VI; Elite/Greater farming.
Greater bosses	45-70	Protection VI-VII.
Ancient bosses	60-90	Protection VII-VIII.
Dragon window	~80-100+	Full Prot VIII + Power X is a strong four-player target.
Post-End	100-120+	Protection IX and stronger Legendary gear.
Wither window	~120-140+	Prot IX + Power XI + Sharpness X+ or better.
Mythic bosses	140-200+	Enchants move well beyond vanilla and named relics matter.
Endless Ruin	200+	Levels 25-255, high-Luck fishing and genetic resource lines become increasingly relevant.

NO FINAL COMFORT POINT

Age of Ruin is intended to remain playable after the vanilla "end." Days and Corruption keep raising Threat, the Nether keeps its extra pressure, ordinary mobs continue evolving, fishing and breeding become parallel progression systems, and level-255 equipment exists for worlds that survive long enough to need it.

A strong server therefore develops multiple economies at once: combat Souls, boss relics, extreme enchanting, high-Luck fishing and selectively bred animal bloodlines. None of those systems is intended to replace the others.